INAUGURAL AFRICAN MEDICINES AGENCY WEEK (1ST AMA WEEK)

CONCEPT NOTE, AGENDA AND PROGRAMME — VERSION 3.2

Theme: Building Africa's Regulatory Future Together — From National Strength to Continental Impact

| 25–30 October 2026 | Kigali, Rwanda

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Document	Concept Note, Agenda and Programme
Version	3.2 — consolidated. Supersedes version 3.1 and all earlier drafts.
Prepared by	AMA Secretariat — Internal Organising Committee
Date	8 October 2026
Status	Draft — latest consolidated version, for sharing
Scope of this version	Incorporates the Official Opening concept note in full at Section 8.3, aligns the structure and format of every convening, and carries the annotated agendas of the five Technical Committees meeting during the Week at Section 9.

1. Background

The African Medicines Agency represents a landmark achievement in Africa's progress towards health security, sovereignty and self-reliance. The Treaty for the establishment of the Agency was adopted by the Assembly of the African Union in February 2019, building on the foundation laid by continental regulatory harmonisation efforts under the Pharmaceutical Manufacturing Plan for Africa. Following the entry into force of the AMA Treaty in November 2021 and the subsequent establishment of the Agency's governance structures, AMA has been operational since October 2025. It operates from its headquarters in Kigali, Rwanda under the host country agreement between the African Union and the Republic of Rwanda.

Under the AMA Treaty, the Agency's role is to coordinate and strengthen continental regulatory systems: to provide scientific opinions on medical products of continental interest, to promote reliance and mutual recognition, to strengthen the capacity of National Regulatory Authorities (NRAs) and Regional Economic Communities (RECs), and to support the harmonisation of regulatory requirements across the continent. AMA works with, and adds value to, national regulatory authorities (NRAs) who remain the sole authorities for giving regulatory approvals in their countries in line with national laws. AMA's role This distinction between AMA's coordinating and scientific role and the sovereign decision-making functions and mandates of NRAs runs through the design of the 1st AMA Week.

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The inaugural AMA week is taking place at a demanding moment. The continent continues to face substandard and falsified medical products, recurrent public health emergencies, and unmet need for equitable access to quality-assured medicines, vaccines and diagnostics. At the same time, the ambition articulated in the Partnerships for African Vaccine Manufacturing framework, that Africa should manufacture 60% of the vaccines it needs by 2040, depends on regulatory systems capable of supporting innovation, enabling market access, assuring product quality, and building confidence in locally produced products.

The 1st AMA Week is therefore convened to consolidate the Agency's operational foundation: to advance the substantive work of its Technical Committees, to launch its Capacity Strengthening and Regulatory Innovation & Manufacturing Readiness Hubs, to convene Heads of National Regulatory Authorities in collaboration with WHO, and to establish a structured channel of engagement with industry. It also offers opportunity for heads of NRAs in Africa to meet within the framework of Network of Heads of Africa NRAs that was established in 2026.

2. Rationale

The 1st AMA Week is convened as a platform for AMA to showcase its work and interact with NRAs, RECs, AU institutions, partners and industry stakeholders, to accelerate implementation of the Agency's mandate, strengthen regulatory systems, and mobilise political and technical support for access to safe, quality-assured and effective medical products. Four considerations shape the event.

- The Agency's Technical Committees are the instrument through which continental technical work is done. The Committees' workplans, procedural documents and priority deliverables need to be settled and visible to the NRAs that will rely on them.
- Reliance, joint assessments and joint inspections depend on confidence between NRAs. That confidence is built through direct engagement, which is why AMA Week includes a dedicated annual meeting of Heads of NRAs, building on the legacy of the AMRC.
- Local manufacturing and innovation depend on predictable regulatory pathways. Industry needs a transparent, recognised channel of engagement with the Agency rather than ad hoc contact, which is the purpose of the Manufacturing and Innovation Day, the Open House, and the Regulatory Innovation and Manufacturing Readiness Hub.
- Enhancing the capacity of State Parties' NRAs and RECs to regulate medical products is the main objective of AMA under the Treaty. Creating platforms and mechanisms for sustainable capacity strengthening requires input from AMA stakeholders, which is why the AMA Capacity Strengthening Hub is launched during the Week and its work will continue to be showcased in subsequent AMA Weeks.

3. Objectives and expected outcomes

3.1 General objective

To launch the operational work programme of the African Medicines Agency by convening its technical structures, so as to advance continental regulatory harmonisation, strengthen cooperation between National Regulatory Authorities, support local manufacturing and innovation, improve emergency preparedness, and establish AMA Week as a continental platform for regulatory cooperation, scientific

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exchange and collective action, while strengthening the role of AMA in supporting regulatory collaboration, convergence and reliance across Africa.

3.2 Specific objectives

No.	Objective
1	To review progress in continental regulatory harmonisation against agreed benchmarks.
2	To showcase regulatory innovations and demonstrate good practice from across the continent.
3	To strengthen professional relationships, peer networks, reliance and work-sharing between National Regulatory Authorities, and between National Regulatory Authorities and AMA.
4	To leverage the scientific and regulatory capacity of Africa's mature and reference regulatory authorities to support joint scientific work, reliance, peer learning and regulatory strengthening across the continent.
5	To establish a structured, transparent channel for regulator–industry engagement.
6	To agree on prioritised, actionable measures that advance local manufacturing and innovation.
7	To strengthen continental preparedness for regulatory response in public health emergencies.
8	To establish a coordinated, needs-driven and sustainable approach to strengthening the regulatory capabilities of African NRAs and regulatory professionals across the continent.
9	To mobilise and align the continental capacity-strengthening ecosystem behind the AMA Capacity Strengthening Hub.
10	To secure the commitment of State Parties, AU Organs, Regional Economic Communities and partners to the Agency's activities and thereby provide the needed financial and technical support to AMA.
11	To adopt the Technical Committee workplans and set the Agency's technical priorities for the coming year.
12	To convene the Network of Heads of African National Regulatory Authorities and adopt its terms of reference as a standing peer-to-peer platform.

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3.3 Expected outcomes

Obj.	Outcome	Evidence that the outcome has been achieved
1	A shared, evidence-based stocktake of harmonisation progress against agreed benchmarks, including joint assessment and reliance pathways.	A documented gap analysis and an agreed set of corrective actions, each with a named owner and a timeline, annexed to the AMRC communiqué.
2	Country and regional case studies presented and captured in a shareable knowledge product.	A published compendium of case studies, and commitments from participating NRAs to adopt or pilot at least one demonstrated practice.
3	Expanded and formalised peer networks between National Regulatory Authorities.	New or renewed cooperation arrangements and an agreed mechanism for information exchange between convenings.

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Obj.	Outcome	Evidence that the outcome has been achieved
4	The maturity level 3 and above network recognised as the scientific backbone on which continental work is built.	A statement of reliance principles adopted at the AMRC.
5	A recognised platform for regulator–industry dialogue established.	A documented set of industry inputs and a defined channel for continuing structured engagement, reflected in the Manufacturing and Innovation Day outcomes paper and the Open House record.
6	An agreed, prioritised set of measures to support local manufacturing and innovation.	A prioritised action list with responsible parties and indicative timelines, adopted through the Regulatory Innovation and Manufacturing Readiness Hub.
7	Strengthened arrangements for regulatory preparedness in emergencies.	Emergency-response elements incorporated into the relevant Technical Committee workplans.
8	Shared understanding and endorsement of the AMA Capacity Strengthening Hub (ACS Hub) model.	Formal expressions of support from key stakeholder groups; agreement on the ACS Hub's role as the continental coordination mechanism for capacity strengthening; stakeholder feedback demonstrating understanding of the model.
9	Stakeholder commitment to the ACS Hub mobilised.	Partners identifying and committing contributions to the ACS Hub's implementation and sustainability.
10	Strengthened commitments from stakeholders and partners to the Agency's operationalisation.	Partner statements recorded in the AMRC report; co-funding or capacity commitments registered.
11	The Technical Committees constituted, with adopted workplans, procedural documents and elected leaders for those meeting during the Week.	Adopted workplans, elected Chairpersons and Vice-Chairpersons, and Committee reports tabled at the AMRC.
12	The Network of Heads of African NRAs convened, with agreed terms of reference.	Terms of reference adopted and the Network's forward agenda recorded.
13. Cross-cutting	The AMA Capacity Strengthening Hub and the Regulatory Innovation and Manufacturing Hub launched with clear mandates and implementation timelines.	Hub mandates and access arrangements published, and platforms for sharing information and development timelines agreed.

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4. Structure of the 1st AMA Week

The Week comprises eleven convenings across six days. Each has a distinct audience and a distinct output.

Convening	Date	Audience	Output
AMA Manufacturing and Innovation Day	Sunday 25 October	Pharmaceutical, vaccine and medical device industry; manufacturers; product development partnerships, academia; patient associations; AMA partners; invited regulators	Manufacturing and Innovation Day outcomes paper and an agreed channel for continuing engagement
Inauguration of AMA Technical Committees	Monday 26 October, morning	Open Session: Committee members, Governing Board, Heads of NRAs, RECs, partners, industry, media	Committees formally inaugurated;
Technical Committee Meetings I	Monday 26 October, afternoon	Closed Session: Technical Committee members only	TC members oriented on terms of reference, rules of procedure and the AMA strategy; Draft workplans and procedural documents under consideration
AMA Regulatory Innovation and Manufacturing Readiness Hub and AMA Capacity Strengthening Hub Open House	Monday 26 October, afternoon (parallel)	Industry, partners and stakeholders	Hubs offerings understood; engagement routes agreed
Official Opening of AMA Week and official launch of the two AMA Hubs	Tuesday 27 October, morning	Government Officials, Ministers, AU principals, Heads of NRAs, RECs, partners, industry, media	Formal opening; both Hub Strategies launched
Annual Meeting of the RCOREs	Tuesday 27 October, afternoon	Regional Centers of Regulatory Excellence members	Progress review and alignment with the Capacity Strengthening Hub Strategy
Meeting of alumni of the African Regulators Leadership Programme (ARLP)	Tuesday 27 October, afternoon	ARLP Alumni	Meeting outcomes from the ARLP Alumni meeting
Meeting between AMA and RECs Coordinators	Tuesday 27 October, afternoon (parallel), continuing Wednesday 28 morning	AMA Secretariat and REC coordinators	Coordination and alignment on regulatory harmonisation and the role of RECs

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Convening	Date	Audience	Output
Technical Committee Meetings II	Wednesday 28 October	Closed Session: Technical Committee members only	Adopted workplans and procedural documents; reports to the AMRC
2nd in-person Meeting of the Network of Heads of African NRAs	Wednesday 28 October, afternoon	Heads of National Regulatory Authorities	Terms of reference and future work areas agreed
African Medicines Regulators Conference (Annual Meeting of Heads of NRAs, with WHO)	Thursday 29 – Friday 30 October	Heads of NRAs, Committee Chairs, RECs coordinators, WHO, and the Chairperson and Vice-Chairperson of the AMA Partnership Platform — closed	Adopted Kigali Communiqué with a measurable commitments matrix

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5. Participants

Participation is by invitation. The categories and numbers below are planning assumptions used for costing, venue sizing and logistics.

Category	Indicative number	Notes
Heads of National Regulatory Authorities and AMA Focal persons/delegates from AU Member States	110	Core participants in the AMRC and in the Network meeting on 28 October. Delegation size assumed at two per authority.
Members of the seven Technical Committees	63	Nine members per Committee. Some overlap with NRA delegations.
Ministers of Health and ministerial delegations	10	For the Official Opening on 27 October.
AMA Governing Board members	9	All members of the Governing Board.
AU Organs — AUC HHS, Africa CDC, AUDA-NEPAD and the AfCFTA Secretariat	20	Speaking roles at the Official Opening and in partnership sessions.
Regional Economic Communities — secretariats and coordinators	16	Eight RECs, two representatives each. Principal participants in the AMA–RECs meeting.
WHO — headquarters, AFRO, EMRO and country offices	15	Strategic partner and co-convener of the AMRC.
Development partners and the AMA Partnership Platform	Maximum of 100	May attend the Manufacturing and Innovation Day, the Inauguration, the Open House and the Official Opening.
Regional Centres of Regulatory Excellence (RCOREs)	20	Annual meeting on the afternoon of 27 October.

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Category	Indicative number	Notes
ARLP alumni	30	Alumni meeting on the afternoon of 27 October confirmed.
Industry association representatives	Maximum of 150	Manufacturing and Innovation Day on 25 October and the Open House on 26 October; approximately 10 continuing to the Official Opening on 27 October.
Media	25	Accredited for the Inauguration, the Official Opening, the Open House and press briefings only.
AMA Secretariat, rapporteurs and interpreters	30 staff; 20 rapporteurs; 10 interpreters	Excludes supplier personnel.
Indicative planning total (unique participants, allowing for overlap)	400 - 500	Venue specification is sized on 400 to 500 in plenary. Approximately 250 participants are self-funded but are included in the conference package.

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6. Dates, venue and language

Item	Detail
Contracted event period	25 to 30 October 2026
Public description of dates	Inaugural AMA Week, 25 to 30 October 2026: 25 October, AMA Manufacturing and Innovation Day; 26 October, Inauguration of the AMA Technical Committees and the Open House; 27 October, Official Opening of AMA Week and launch of the two AMA Hubs; 28 October, Technical Committee meetings and the Network of Heads of African NRAs meeting; 29 to 30 October, the African Medicines Regulators Conference.
Host city	Kigali, Republic of Rwanda
Venue, 25 to 27 October	Marriott Hotel, Kigali
Venue, 28 to 30 October	Ubumwe Grande Hotel, Kigali
Working language	English
Interpretation	Simultaneous interpretation into French and Portuguese for all plenary sessions, the Inauguration, the Official Opening, the AMRC and the Manufacturing and Innovation Day. Breakout and Committee sessions are covered as specified in the respective programmes.
Documentation	Core documents (concept note, programme, communiqué, Committee reports) in English, French and Portuguese. Working papers in English.

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7. Master schedule

This is the controlled schedule for the 1st AMA Week. Where any other document differs, this schedule prevails. Arrival days are staggered by delegate group so that airport facilitation, accommodation check-in and transport are not concentrated on a single day.

Date	Morning	Afternoon	Evening
Saturday 24 October	Arrivals: industry delegates and speakers — airport facilitation, check-in and rest	Arrivals continue; technical set-up and rehearsal	—
Sunday 25 October	AMA Manufacturing and Innovation Day	AMA Manufacturing and Innovation Day	Opening Reception (18:00–19:30)
Sunday 25 October	Arrivals: Technical Committee members	Arrivals continue; Committee document packs issued at check-in	—
Monday 26 October	Inauguration of the AMA Technical Committees (open), followed by the orientation plenary	Running in parallel: Technical Committee Meetings I (members only); AMA Regulatory Innovation and Manufacturing Readiness Hub and AMA Capacity Strengthening Hub Open House	Free evening — bilaterals and networking
Monday 26 October	Arrivals: AMA partners, RECs, AU Organs and RCORE representatives	Arrivals continue	—
Tuesday 27 October	Official Opening of AMA Week and launch of the two AMA Hubs Strategies	Running in parallel: RCOREs Annual Meeting; ARLP Alumni Meeting; Meeting between AMA and RECs Coordinators	AMA Week Dinner
Tuesday 27 October	Arrivals: Heads of NRAs and AMRC delegations; ministerial and VIP arrivals	Arrivals continue	—
Wednesday 28 October	Running in parallel: Technical Committee Meetings II (members only); AMA–RECs Meeting	Running in parallel: Technical Committee Meetings II (members only); 2nd in-person Meeting of the Network of Heads of African NRAs	Free evening — bilaterals, Side events and networking
Thursday 29 October	AMRC Day One (closed)	AMRC Day One (closed)	AMRC Dinner
Friday 30 October	AMRC Day Two (closed)	AMRC Day Two; closing lunch; departures and airport facilitation	

The venue changes on 28 October: sessions from 25 to 27 October are held at the Marriott Hotel and from 28 to 30 October at the Ubumwe Grande Hotel.

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8. Detailed programme

8.1 AMA Manufacturing and Innovation Day — Sunday 25 October 2026

Convened as a full day and sequenced so that each substantive matter receives its own session: an overview of the continental regulatory ecosystem, then eligibility criteria, then the fee structure, then the African Pooled Procurement Mechanism, and finally the offerings of the Regulatory Innovation and Manufacturing Readiness Hub. Each consultation session carries its own discussion and industry inputs.

Marriott Hotel, Kigali, Rwanda | 08:00–17:30

Master of Ceremonies: **Prof Alex Dodoo, AMA and Mr Robert Matilu, UNITAID**

Programme

Time	Session	Speaker / Lead
08:00–09:00	**Arrival, registration and networking**	AMA
Session 1 · Opening and setting the scene		
09:00–09:15	**Welcome address**	**Dr Delese Mimi Darko** Director-General, African Medicines Agency
09:15–09:35	**Keynote address: Health Security or Sound Business? The Case for Medical Products Manufacturing in Africa**	**Dr Amit N Thakker** Executive Chairman, Africa Health Business
09:35–10:30	**High-level panel: Manufacturing, Innovation and Market Access in Africa** Panellists: FAPMA · EAFPMA · IFPMA · DNDi · Biovac Five-minute opening remarks from each panellist (no slides), followed by moderated Q&A with the audience	**Moderator: Dr Amit N Thakker** Executive Chairman, Africa Health Business
10:30–11:00	**Tea break**	
Session 2 · Manufacturing in practice: challenges and success stories		
11:00–11:15	**Challenges in vaccine manufacturing in Africa**	**VACSERA** Egypt

Time	Session	Speaker / Lead
11:15–11:30	**Challenges in medical device manufacturing in Africa**	**FIND, the global alliance for diagnostics**
11:30–11:45	**An African manufacturer's journey to WHO prequalification of antiretrovirals**	**Universal Corporation Ltd (UCL)** Kenya
11:45–12:15	**Open forum: Overcoming challenges in medical products manufacturing in Africa**	**VACSERA, FIND and UCL** With all participants
Session 3 · AMA in operation: what it means for industry		
12:15–12:30	**The AMA operational phase: what it means for industry**	**Clariator Mvurume** Technical Expert, AMA
12:30–12:50	**The AMA Coordinated Continental Procedure**	**Alex Juma** Technical Expert, AMA
12:50–13:00	**Discussion**	**All**
13:00–14:00	**Lunch**	
Session 4 · AMA as an enabler of local manufacturing		
14:00–14:15	**AMA as a facilitator for local manufacturing and market access in Africa**	**EAFPM Representative**
14:15–14:35	**The AMA fee structure**	**Nathaniel Nkrumah** Technical Expert, AMA
14:35–15:00	**Open forum: The AMA fee structure**	**Moderator: Dr Amit N Thakker** Executive Chairman, Africa Health Business
Session 5 · Market access through pooled procurement		

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Director-General, Medicines Control Authority of Zimbabwe

Time	Session	Speaker / Lead
15:00–15:20	**The African Pooled Procurement Mechanism (APPM)**	**Dr Mariatou Tala Jallow** Director, African Pooled Procurement Mechanism, Africa CDC
15:20–15:40	**Quality assurance and the APPM: the role of AMA**	**Nkaelang Modutlwa** AMA
15:40–16:00	**Open forum: The APPM and AMA quality assurance**	**Africa CDC and AMA**
16:00–16:30	**Coffee break**	
Session 6 · Closing Session		
16:30–17:00	**Closing plenary: How can regulators, industry and product development partnerships work together to improve local manufacturing and market access in Africa?**	**FAPMA representative**
17:00–17:20	**Key outcomes and next steps**	**Manufacturing and Innovation Day Lead**
17:20–17:30	**Closing remarks**	**Dr Delese Mimi Darko** Director-General, African Medicines Agency
Evening		
18:00–19:30	**AMA Week opening reception** For all arriving delegates	**AMA Secretariat**

FAPMA – Federation of African Pharmaceutical Manufacturers Associations; IFPMA – International Federation of Pharmaceutical Manufacturers & Associations; DNDi – Drugs for Neglected Diseases initiative; Africa CDC – Africa Centres for Disease Control and Prevention.

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8.2 Monday 26 October 2026 — Inauguration, Technical Committee Meetings I and the Open House

8.2.1 Morning: Inauguration of the seven AMA Technical Committees (open)

Time	Activity	Lead / speaker
08:30–09:00	Registration and seating	AMA Secretariat and Protocol
09:00–09:10	Opening and purpose of the inauguration	Master of Ceremonies
09:10–09:25	The Role of AMA Technical Committees in Delivering the Agency's Work Programme	Dr Delese Mimi Dark, AMA Director-General
09:25–09:40	**Partner statements** World Health Organization (WHO) · European Medicines Agency (EMA) · Gates Foundation *Five minutes per partner*	Partner representatives
09:40–09:55	**Introduction of the AMA Technical Committees and their members**	**Dr Delese Mimi Darko** Director-General, African Medicines Agency
09:55–10:15	Statement and formal inauguration of the AMA Technical Committees	Chairperson of the AMA Governing Board and the Director-General
10:15–10:30	Group photograph	Communications team
10:30–11:00	Coffee break	—
11:00–12:30	Orientation plenary for AMA Technical Committee members (Closed Session)	AMA Director-General and Secretariat leads
12:30–13:30	Lunch	—

8.2.2 Afternoon: Technical Committee Meetings I (members only, closed)

From 13:30 to 17:00 the Committees meet in parallel closed session. Five Committees are scheduled to meet during the Week: Evaluation of Medicines, Vaccines and Biologicals; Regulatory Inspections (GMP and GCP); Market Intelligence and Control; Vigilance; and Quality Control Laboratories and Laboratory Networks. Each annotated agenda is at Section 9.

The Technical Committee on Medical Devices, Diagnostics and Emerging Technologies Assessment and the Technical Committee on Clinical Trials Oversight are not scheduled to meet during the 1st AMA Week and will be convened separately.

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Common business of the first half-day: adoption of the agenda; election of the Chairperson and Vice-Chairperson; discussion of the Committee's terms of reference and rules of procedure; consideration of the draft procedures and frameworks assigned to the Committee; identification of priority technical deliverables; and first reading of the instruments tabled. The Committee Chairs' debrief with the AMA Secretariat follows at 17:00.

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8.2.3 Afternoon, in parallel: AMA Regulatory Innovation and Manufacturing Readiness Hub and AMA Capacity Strengthening Hub Open House

Regulatory Innovation and Manufacturing Readiness Hub

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Launch and Open House

27 October 2026 | Marriott Hotel, Kigali, Rwanda
Launch: 11:00–11:40 | Open House: 14:00–17:00

About the day

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The Regulatory Innovation and Manufacturing Readiness Hub (RIMR Hub) is AMA's front door for African innovators and manufacturers: a regulator-enabler that helps them understand regulatory expectations, strengthen readiness and navigate national, regional and continental pathways. It complements, and does not replace, the roles of NRAs and RECs.

The morning launch formally introduces the Hub and shows its services in action through a live demonstration. In the afternoon, the RIMR Hub and the AMA Capacity Strengthening Hub open their doors for a working exchange with industry, partners and regulators: what each Hub offers, how to access it, and what it needs from participants.

Programme

TIME	SESSION	SPEAKER / LEAD
MORNING · LAUNCH OF THE RIMR HUB | Plenary		
11:00–11:05	**The purpose of the AMA Regulatory Innovation and Manufacturing Readiness Hub**	**Dr Delese Mimi Darko** Director-General, African Medicines Agency
11:05–11:13	**RIMR Hub launch video** A short film from the access challenge to the Hub's services, with testimonials from partners, manufacturers and innovators	**Communications team** RIMR Hub Technical Lead
11:13–11:18	**From launch video to live demonstration: the RIMR Hub in action**	**RIMR Hub Technical Lead**

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TIME	SESSION	SPEAKER / LEAD
11:18–11:23	Live demonstration: from manufacturer inquiry to output	RIMR Hub Technical Lead With the Communications team
11:23–11:28	Stakeholder engagement map	RIMR Hub Technical Lead
11:28–11:33	Engagement pathways: how to work with the Hub	RIMR Hub Technical Lead
11:33–11:38	Call to action and formal launch of the RIMR Hub	Dr Delese Mimi Darko Director-General, African Medicines Agency
11:38–11:40	Vote of thanks and close	AMA Chief of Staff

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The two Hubs in open session with industry, partners and stakeholders. This is a working exchange rather than a presentation exercise: each Hub sets out what it offers, how authorities and manufacturers access it, and what it needs from participants.

Time	Session	Lead
14:00–14:15	Welcome and overview: recap of the RIMR Hub introduction from the Manufacturing and Innovation Day; introduction of the Capacity Strengthening Hub as a complementary strategic initiative; the afternoon flow and engagement format	AMA leadership

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Time	Session	Lead
14:15–15:25	Capacity Strengthening Hub — Formal introduction of the Hub's mission, model and strategic mandate; engagement pathways for NRAs, technical partners and institutions Regulatory Innovation and Manufacturing Readiness Hub; Formal introduction of the Hub's mission, model and strategic mandate; engagement pathways for NRAs, technical partners and institutions Followed by questions and answers. Audience: NRAs, RCOREs, academic institutions and technical partners. *In parallel:* RIMR Hub interactive exhibition, bilateral Hub engagements and networking.	AMA Hub Leads
15:25–16:50	Interactive exhibition and Hub engagement: breakout and Hub booths, networking, working tea	Capacity Strengthening and RIMR Hub teams
16:50–17:00	Closing remarks	AMA leadership

AMA Capacity Strengthening Hub (ACS Hub)

Launch

Building Africa's Regulatory Future Together: From National Strength to Continental Impact

27 October 2026 | Marriott Hotel, Kigali, Rwanda | 10:00–11:00

About the launch

The AMA Capacity Strengthening Hub (ACS Hub) is AMA's continental coordination platform for needs-driven, sustainable regulatory capacity strengthening. Building on the network of Regional Centres of Regulatory Excellence (RCOREs), it connects training, mentorship, expert networks and institutional strengthening with the priorities of National Regulatory Authorities (NRAs), Regional Economic Communities (RECs) and the continent, measuring success by strengthened regulatory capability rather than the number of trainings delivered.

Held immediately after the Official Opening of AMA Week, the launch presents the Hub's mandate and work programme, hears directly from NRAs on their capacity needs, and concludes with the official launch of the ACS Hub Strategy by the Director-General.

Programme

Time	Session	Speaker / Lead
Launch of the ACS Hub | Plenary		
10:00–10:20	**The ACS Hub: mandate, work programme and how authorities access the Hub**	**Capacity Strengthening Hub Lead**

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Time	Session	Speaker / Lead
10:20–10:40	**Challenges and opportunities for capacity strengthening in NRAs** Perspectives from two National Regulatory Authorities	**Heads of NRAs**
10:40–11:00	**Open forum** Questions and discussion with participants	**Moderator: Nathaniel Nkrumah**, AMA and Lead, ACS Hub
11:00–11:10	**Official launch of the AMA Capacity Strengthening Hub Strategy**	**Dr Delese Mimi Darko** Director-General, African Medicines Agency

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8.3 Tuesday 27 October 2026 — Official Opening of AMA Week and launch of the two AMA Hubs

Date	Tuesday 27 October 2026
Venue	Marriott Hotel, Kigali, Republic of Rwanda
Convened by	African Medicines Agency
Theme	Building Africa's Regulatory Future Together — From National Strength to Continental Impact

A high-level opening platform to align political leadership, regulatory authorities, public health institutions and partners around the transition from strong national systems to coordinated continental impact.

Background

African countries are strengthening national regulatory systems at different levels of maturity. The next phase is to connect these national capabilities through coordinated continental mechanisms that promote regulatory convergence, reliance, work-sharing and timely access to quality-assured medical products. The African Medicines Agency provides a platform for this process by complementing the functions of National Regulatory Authorities and Regional Economic Communities and supporting coherent regulatory action across the continent.

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AMA Week brings together political leaders, regulators, African Union institutions, the African Union Commission, the World Health Organization, industry, development partners and other stakeholders to advance a shared regulatory agenda. The Official Opening sets the political and strategic direction for the

Week, demonstrates collective ownership of the Agency's operationalisation, and connects continental regulatory cooperation to Africa's public health and manufacturing priorities.

The theme of AMA Week is interpreted as follows:

- Building together signals shared responsibility among NRAs, RECs, AMA, industry and partners.
- National strength recognises that effective continental regulation depends on capable, trusted and sustainable NRAs.
- Continental impact focuses on convergence, coordinated decision-making, regulatory innovation, manufacturing readiness and improved access to quality, safe and effective medical products.

The opening day also launches two implementation-oriented structures: the AMA Capacity Strengthening Hub and the Regulatory Innovation and Manufacturing Readiness Hub. Their launch translates the Week's theme into practical support for national authorities, innovators and manufacturers, while reinforcing the link between national performance and continental outcomes.

Strategic proposition: strong national regulatory authorities are the foundation. Coordinated continental action is the multiplier.

Purpose

To formally launch AMA Week, secure high-level political and institutional commitment, introduce the Week's strategic priorities, and create a common platform for advancing Africa's regulatory future from national capacity to coordinated continental action.

Objectives

No.	Objective
1	Officially open AMA Week and articulate its intended outcomes, structure and priority themes.
2	Reaffirm high-level commitment to the operationalisation and sustainability of AMA.
3	Position strong national regulatory systems as the foundation for effective continental cooperation.
4	Launch the AMA Capacity Strengthening Hub and the Regulatory Innovation and Manufacturing Readiness Hub.
5	Examine how regulators can respond to Africa's changing disease epidemiology and public health priorities.
6	Promote collaboration across health, trade, manufacturing and development institutions.

Expected outcomes

No.	Expected outcome
1	A shared understanding of the strategic direction and expected results of AMA Week.
2	Renewed political and institutional support for coordinated medical products regulation in Africa.
3	Greater clarity on how national authorities can engage with and benefit from AMA's continental mechanisms.

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No.	Expected outcome
4	Formal visibility for the mandates, work programmes and access pathways of the two AMA Hubs.
5	High-level recommendations on regulatory responses to priority health needs and support for African manufacturing.

Participants

Ministers and senior government representatives from States Parties and Member States; AMA, the African Union Commission, AUDA-NEPAD, Africa CDC and the AfCFTA Secretariat; National Regulatory Authorities and Regional Economic Communities; the World Health Organization; manufacturers, industry and innovators; development partners; and accredited media.

Programme

Time	Activity	Moderator / speaker
08:00–08:45	Registration	AMA Secretariat
SESSION I: OPENING SESSION — Session Chairperson: Dr Yossounon Chabi, Chairperson, AMA Governing Board		
08:45–08:50	Meeting objectives, structure, themes and outcomes (5 minutes)	Session Chairperson
08:50–08:55	Welcome Remarks from AMA	H.E. Dr Delese Mimi Darko, Director General, AMA
08:55–09:05	Welcome remarks from the Republic of Rwanda	Dr Sabin Nsanzimana, Minister of Health, Republic of Rwanda
09:05–09:10	Statement from AUDA-NEPAD	H.E. Mrs Nardos Bekele-Thomas, Chief Executive Officer, AUDA-NEPAD
09:10–09:15	Statement from Africa CDC	H.E. Dr Jean Kaseya, Director General, Africa CDC
09:15–09:20	Statement from the AfCFTA)	H.E. Wamkele Keabetswe Mene, Secretary-General, AfCFTA
09:20–09:25	Statement by the AMA Special Envoy	Hon. Dr Michel Sidibé, AMA Special Envoy
09:25–09:35	Keynote speech from the AUC	H.E. Amb. Amma A. Twum-Amoah, Commissioner for Health, Humanitarian Affairs and Social Development, AUC
09:35–09:45	Keynote speech from WHO	Dr Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus, Director-General, WHO

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Time	Activity	Moderator / speaker
09:45–09:50	Official opening	Dr Abdelmadjid Abderahim Mahamat, Minister of Health, Republic of Chad
10:00–10:30	Group photograph and tea/coffee break	AMA Communications Team
SESSION II: LAUNCH OF THE AMA HUBS AND UPDATES — Session Moderator: Hon. Dr Michel Sidibé, AMA Special Envoy. Rapporteurs: Lerato Moeti, Technical Officer, AMA; Tariro Sithole, Technical Officer, WHO		
10:30–10:40	AMA Capacity Strengthening Hub — mandate, work programme and how authorities access the Hub	AMA Hub Lead
10:40–10:50	Regulatory Innovation and Manufacturing Readiness Hub — mandate, work programme and access	AMA Hub Lead
10:50–11:00	Official launch of the two Hubs Strategies	H.E. Dr Delese Mimi Darko, Director General, AMA
11:00–11:20	Presentation: the changing disease epidemiology and public health priorities for Africa	H.E. Dr Jean Kaseya, Director General, Africa CDC
11:20–12:45	High-level panel: the role of regulators in addressing African public health priorities. Panel: Mr Richard Rukwata, Director General, Medicines Control Authority of Zimbabwe (to be confirmed); Dr Ali El-Ghamrawy, Chairperson, Egyptian Drug Authority (to be confirmed); Mr Emmanuel Mujuru, Chairperson, FAPMA (industry representative); Chairperson, FEAPM (regional industry representative); Prof. Mohamed Janabi, Regional Director, WHO AFRO; Dr Hanan Balkhy, Regional Director, WHO EMRO	Moderator: Prof. Alexander Dodoo, Senior Advisor to the Director General, AMA
12:45–12:55	Closing and housekeeping announcements	Dr Yossounon Chabi, Chairperson, AMA Governing Board
13:00–14:00	Lunch break	All

Afternoon, in parallel (14:15–17:30)

Convening	Programme
Annual Meeting of the RCOREs	14:15–14:30 opening and objectives (AMA Secretariat and the RCORE network convener); 14:30–15:30 RCORE progress reports and review of training delivery; 15:30–15:50 coffee; 15:50–16:50 aligning the RCORE network with the Capacity Strengthening Hub Strategy launched that morning; 16:50–17:20 commitments, conclusions and forward actions; 17:20–17:30 close.
Meeting between AMA and RECs Coordinators	14:15–14:30 opening; 14:30–15:45 REC reports on regional harmonisation and the state of regional regulatory systems; 15:45–16:00 coffee; 16:00–17:00 the role of RECs in the continental architecture and the division of labour with AMA; 17:00–17:15 agreed coordination arrangements. Continues on the morning of Wednesday 28 October.

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In parallel throughout the afternoon: partner bilateral meetings; media interviews; and the technical rehearsal for Wednesday. The AMA Week Dinner follows in the evening.

8.4 Wednesday 28 October 2026 — Technical Committee Meetings II and the Network of Heads of African NRAs

Time	Committee rooms	Parallel convening
09:00–12:30	Technical Committee Meetings II — five Committees in parallel closed session: consideration and adoption of the procedures and frameworks tabled; finalisation of workplans	AMA–RECs Meeting (continuation of the Tuesday session)
12:30–14:00	Lunch	Lunch
14:00–16:00	Technical Committee Meetings II continued: adoption of workplans and agreement of each Committee's report and recommendations to the AMRC	2nd in-person Meeting of the Network of Heads of African NRAs, 14:00 – 17:30 — see below
16:00–17:00	Joint consolidation session of the Committees: alignment of workplans and preparation of the Committee reports to the AMRC (Chairpersons, Vice-Chairpersons and accountable officers)	Network meeting continues
Evening	Rapporteurs draft the Committee reports for presentation to the AMRC	Free evening — bilaterals and networking

2nd in-person Meeting of the Network of Heads of African NRAs — 14:00–17:30

The Network of Heads of African National Regulatory Authorities brings together all African NRAs and was established in Kigali in January 2026. This is its second in-person convening. It is a working session of Heads of authorities, held the day before the Conference so that the Network's priorities can shape the AMRC agenda rather than follow it.

Time	Activity
14:00–14:15	Opening and purpose of the Network (AMA Director-General)
14:15–15:15	The case for a standing peer network: functions, membership and rules of engagement
15:15–15:35	Coffee break
15:35–16:30	Consideration and adoption of the draft terms of reference of the Network, including its governance, secretariat arrangements and meeting cadence
16:30–17:15	Work Plan for 2026
17:15–17:30	Conclusions

The draft terms of reference of the Network and its 2027 workplan are circulated to Heads of NRAs at least ten working days in advance; a document tabled on the day cannot be adopted on the day.

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8.5 African Medicines Regulators Conference — Thursday 29 and Friday 30 October 2026

Theme: Regulatory Reliance — Accelerating Innovation, Access and Regulatory Excellence in Africa.

Tag line: Trusted Decisions, Smarter Regulation, Better Health Outcomes.

Hosted by the African Medicines Agency in collaboration with the World Health Organization. A closed meeting of Heads of National Regulatory Authorities. No media access; recording and streaming as determined by the Director-General.

Day One — Thursday 29 October 2026

Time	Activity	Moderator / speaker
08:30–09:00	Registration — Heads of NRAs and accredited delegations	AMA Secretariat
09:00–10:00	SESSION I: OPENING SESSION.	Session Moderator:
9:00 – 19:15	Welcome Address from the AMA Director-General (15 minutes)	H.E. Dr Delese Mimi Darko
9:15 – 9:20	Remarks from the Chairperson of the AMA Governing Board (5 minutes)	Dr Yossounon Chabi
9:20 – 9:25	Remarks from the Director General, Rwanda FDA	Prof. Raymond Muganga
9:25-9:40	The AMA-WHO Framework for Collaboration: a landmark agreement for regulatory systems strengthening in Africa	Mr Hiiti Sillo, WHO HQ, Geneva
9:40 – 10:00	Keynote address: Regulatory Reliance as a Catalyst for Innovation, Access and Regulatory Excellence (20 minutes), followed by discussion	To be confirmed — AMA proposal: Dr Fred Siyoi
10:00–10:30	Group photograph and tea/coffee break	All
10:00 – 11:00	Regulatory Systems Strengthening in Africa and Africa's growing number of ML3 NRAs	Mr Hiiti Sillo, Unit Head, Regulation and Safety, WHO headquarters
11:00 – 11:45	Fireside Chat: **How can we share resources to strengthen capacity and accelerate access to quality, safe and efficacious medical products in Africa** **Panelists:** Director General of NAFDAC Director General of EDA Director General of SAHPRA Director General of TFDA Director General of Cameroun	Moderator: Dr Richard Tendayi Rukwata, Director General, MCAZ
11:45-12:15–12:30	Open Forum	All

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Meeting objectives, structure, themes and outcomes (10 minutes)
Session Moderator
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Remarks from WHO (5 minutes)
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Objectives: share the status of AMA operationalisation and the 2027 work programme; expound on the newly launched AMA Hubs; and share updates on the status of regulatory systems in Africa, including planned activities for 2027.
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Time	Activity	Moderator / speaker
12:15–13:00	SESSION III: REPORTS OF THE TECHNICAL COMMITTEES. Each Chairperson presents the Committee's outcomes, adopted workplan and recommendations to Heads of NRAs in 10 minutes. Session Moderator: to be confirmed.	The Chairpersons of the five Committees that met during the Week
13:00–14:00	Lunch break	All
14:00–15:30	SESSION IV: PARALLEL TECHNICAL TRACKS. Track A — substandard and falsified medical products: detection, market intelligence and enforcement, with contributions from Nigeria, Zambia and Egypt followed by an AMA question-and-answer segment; proposed Chair: the Head of the National Regulatory Authority of Nigeria. Track B — safety monitoring and vigilance, including signal management and post-market surveillance. Track C — AMA eligibility criteria for products, the continental listing pathway and reliance.	Track chairs drawn from Heads of NRAs; a rapporteur per track
15:30–16:00	Tea break	All
16:00–17:30	SESSION V: REGULATORY RELIANCE IN AFRICA — FACTS, MYTHS AND PRACTICAL REALITIES The objectives of this session are share the principles of reliance and lessons learnt from implementing reliance mechanisms; discuss key success factors and challenges; share experiences of building trust among regulators within a regional network; identify strategic interventions to accelerate reliance among African NRAs and on the AMA.	Session Moderator: TBC
16:00–16:25	Presentation on the principles of reliance and reliance mechanisms	WHO
16:25–16:35	Country experience	A maturity level 3 country
16:35–16:45	Country experience	A non-maturity level 3 country
16:45–17:05	Panel discussion including the presenters: SADC REC (5 minutes); EMA (5 minutes); AMA (5 minutes)	All
17:05–17:30	Questions and answers	All
17:30 – 17:45 – 18:00	Day one summation	Conference rapporteur
18:00–19:00	Closed session: update on ongoing pharmacovigilance work	Restricted attendance — to be confirmed
19:30	AMRC Dinner	Protocol team

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Day Two — Friday 30 October 2026

Time	Activity	Moderator / speaker
09:00–09:15	Day one reflections and introduction to day two	Conference rapporteur
09:15–10:30	SESSION VII: REGULATORY EXCELLENCE IN THE DIGITAL AGE — ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE, DATA AND DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION. Objectives: present case studies from selected countries; discuss key success factors and challenges; share global best practice; propose recommendations for continental adoption.	Session Moderator: to be confirmed
09:15–09:25	Country presentation	To be confirmed
09:25–09:35	Country presentation	To be confirmed
09:35–09:45	WHO	To be confirmed
09:45–09:55	EMA	TBD
09:55–10:05	AMA	To be confirmed
10:05–10:30	Questions and answers	All
10:30–11:00	Tea break	All
11:00–13:00	SESSION VIII: SECURING THE PRODUCT LIFECYCLE — INTEGRATING QUALITY, SAFETY SURVEILLANCE AND MARKET INTELLIGENCE ACROSS AFRICA. Objectives: consult NRAs on the NARL overarching continental procedure and the market surveillance procedure; align quality standards and safety surveillance protocols across African NRAs; identify practical approaches for sharing real-time market intelligence to detect and prevent substandard and falsified medical products; formulate strategies for end-to-end lifecycle oversight through regional and continental reliance pathways.	. Session Moderator: to be confirmed.
11:00–11:20	Consultation on the NARL overarching continental procedure	AMA Technical Lead with the Chairperson of the Quality Control Laboratories and Laboratory Networks Committee
11:20–11:35	Questions and answers	All
11:35–11:55	Consultation on the continental market surveillance procedure	AMA Technical Lead with the Chairperson of the Market Intelligence and Control Committee
11:55–12:10	Questions and answers	All
12:10–12:25	Consultation on the continental framework for vigilance	AMA Technical Lead with the Chairperson of the Vigilance Committee
12:25–12:35	Questions and answers	All

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Time	Activity	Moderator / speaker
12:35–13:00	Panel discussion including the presenters: country (5 minutes); EAC REC (5 minutes); WHO (5 minutes); EMA (5 minutes)	All
13:00–14:00	Lunch break	All
14:00–15:00	SESSION IX: FROM CONTINENTAL SCIENTIFIC OPINIONS TO NATIONAL DECISIONS IN MEDICAL PRODUCTS REGULATION Objectives: consult NRAs on the centralised procedures for the evaluation of medical products and for regulatory inspections, and on the AMA scope of products and eligibility criteria; consult NRAs on the procedure for the joint review of clinical trials; discuss success factors and challenges for national implementation.	Session Moderator: to be confirmed.
14:00–14:20	Consultation on the centralised procedures for the evaluation of medical products and for regulatory inspections, and on the AMA scope of products and eligibility criteria	AMA Technical Lead with the Chairpersons of the Evaluation and Regulatory Inspections Committees
14:20–14:35	Questions and answers	All
14:35–14:45	Consultation on the continental procedure for the joint review of clinical trials	AMA Technical Lead
14:45–15:00	Panel discussion including the presenters: country (5 minutes); ECOWAS REC (5 minutes); WHO (5 minutes); EMA (5 minutes), and questions and answers	All
15:00–16:00	SESSION X: STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIPS AND THE WAY FORWARD. Objectives: share and discuss partner perspectives, priorities and plans; develop and adopt actions and commitments.	Session Moderator: to be confirmed.
15:00–15:10	The African Regulatory Leadership Programme	ARLP
15:10–15:25	Panel discussion including the presenter: Chairperson of the AMA Partnership Platform (5 minutes); WHO (5 minutes); AMA (5 minutes)	All
15:25–15:40	Questions and answers	All
15:40–16:00	Adoption of the Kigali Communiqué and the commitments matrix, and closing remarks	H.E. Dr Delese Mimi Darko, Director General, AMA
16:00–16:15	Closing remarks	WHO AFRO Regional Adviser, Mr Mohamed Ismail; WHO EMRO Regional Adviser, Dr Houda Langar; the AMRC Chairperson
16:15–16:30	End of Conference and tea break	All

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8.6 Evening functions

Function	Date and time	Purpose and attendance
Opening Reception	Sunday 25 October, 18:00–19:30	Welcome for all arriving delegates, following the Manufacturing and Innovation Day.
Free evening	Monday 26 October	Bilaterals and networking. No hosted function.
AMA Week Dinner	Tuesday 27 October, evening	Following the Official Opening and the launch of the Hub Strategies. The principal hosted function of the Week; guest list approved by the Director-General's Office.
Free evening	Wednesday 28 October	Bilaterals and networking. No hosted function.
AMRC Dinner	Thursday 29 October, 19:30	Heads of NRAs and invited guests.
Closing Cocktail	Friday 30 October, evening	Following adoption of the Communiqué.

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9. Annotated agendas of the Technical Committees

Five Committees are scheduled to meet during the 1st AMA Week. Each meets twice: Meeting I on the afternoon of Monday 26 October and Meeting II on Wednesday 28 October. Working documents, including the draft 2027 workplan, reach members at least ten working days before 26 October for review and finalisation in session; a Committee cannot be asked to adopt a substantive procedure it first sees in the room.

Common arrangements across the five Committees: the AMA strategy and Secretariat update is delivered once, in the joint orientation plenary on the morning of 26 October and is therefore not repeated in the individual Committee agendas. Each Committee elects its Chairperson and Vice-Chairperson at Meeting I, after the terms of reference and rules of procedure have been considered. Each Chairperson presents the Committee's report and recommendations to the AMRC. The joint consolidation session of all Committees runs on Wednesday 28 October from 16:00 to 17:00.

Two Committees are not scheduled to meet during the Week and will be convened separately: the Technical Committee on Medical Devices, Diagnostics and Emerging Technologies Assessment, and the Technical Committee on Clinical Trials Oversight. Both are nevertheless formally inaugurated with the others on the morning of 26 October. Inspection of medical device manufacturing facilities is dealt with by the Technical Committee on Regulatory Inspections at Section 9.2.

9.1 Technical Committee on the Evaluation of Medicines, Vaccines and Biologicals

Committee	Technical Committee on the Evaluation of Medicines, Vaccines and Biologicals (TC1)
Meeting I	Monday 26 October 2026, 13:30–17:00 — closed, members only
Meeting II	Wednesday 28 October 2026, 09:00–16:00 — closed, members only
Preceded by	Inauguration of the seven AMA Technical Committees and the orientation plenary, Monday 26 October, 09:00–12:30 (open)
Followed by	Joint consolidation session of all seven Committees, Wednesday 28 October, 16:00–17:00
Venue	Marriott Hotel, Kigali (26 October); Ubumwe Grande Hotel, Kigali (28 October). Room allocation to be confirmed
Chairing	Chaired pro tem by the AMA Secretariat until the Chairperson is elected
Secretariat	AMA Secretariat — accountable officer and rapporteur designated before circulation
Documents tabled for decision	Product Eligibility Criteria for continental listing (AMA/TC1/2026/05); Overarching Continental Procedure for Evaluations (AMA/TC1/2026/06)

The Committee meets to constitute itself, to adopt its terms of reference, rules of procedure and workplan, and to take first and second readings of the two substantive instruments tabled for the Week: the Product Eligibility Criteria and the Overarching Continental Procedure for Evaluations. Both are the operational foundation of continental listing, and both are intended for adoption before the Committee Chairperson reports to the African Medicines Regulators Conference on 29 October.

Industry was consulted on the eligibility criteria and the fee structure at the AMA Manufacturing and Innovation Day on 25 October. The record of that consultation is tabled as a background document and the Committee considers it when taking the first reading.

Meeting I — Monday 26 October 2026, 13:30–17:00

Time	Agenda item and purpose	Action	Lead / document
13:30–13:40	Item 1. Opening, welcome and introduction of members. Confirmation of attendance and of the quorum.	Information	AMA Secretariat
13:40–13:50	Item 2. Adoption of the agenda and the programme of work for the two meetings.	Decision	Chair pro tem / AMA/TC1/2026/01
13:50–14:20	Item 3. Terms of reference of the Committee. Presentation of the draft terms, followed by discussion of scope, membership, conflict of interest and declarations, confidentiality, and the Committee's relationship to the Secretariat and to National Regulatory Authorities.	Decision	AMA Secretariat / AMA/TC1/2026/02
14:20–14:45	Item 4. Rules of procedure. Convening of meetings, quorum, decision-making and consensus, subgroups and drafting groups, participation of observers, and record-keeping.	Decision	AMA Secretariat / AMA/TC1/2026/03
14:45–15:10	Item 5. Election of the Chairperson and the Vice-Chairperson of the Committee, in accordance with the rules of procedure adopted at Item 4. Terms of office and handover arrangements.	Decision	AMA Secretariat presiding
15:10–15:30	Coffee break	—	—
15:30–16:20	Item 6. Product Eligibility Criteria — first reading. Presentation of the draft criteria (15 minutes) followed by discussion (35 minutes).	Discussion; text referred to a drafting group	Chairperson / AMA/TC1/2026/05
16:20–16:55	Item 7. Overarching Continental Procedure for Evaluations — first reading. Presentation (15 minutes) and discussion (20 minutes).	Discussion; text referred to a drafting group	Chairperson / AMA/TC1/2026/06
16:55–17:00	Item 8. Summary of the session. Constitution of the two drafting groups, with named members and a reporting time of 09:00 on 28 October. Housekeeping.	Decision	Chairperson
17:00–17:45	Committee Chairs' debrief with the AMA Secretariat	—	—
Evening	Drafting groups work on the revised texts	—	Drafting group convenors

Meeting II — Wednesday 28 October 2026, 09:00–16:00

Time	Agenda item and purpose	Action	Lead / document
09:00–09:15	Item 9. Recap of Meeting I and confirmation of the outcomes recorded. Reports from the two drafting groups.	Information	Chair pro tem; drafting group convenors
09:15–10:30	Item 10. Product Eligibility Criteria — second reading and adoption. Consideration of the revised text, clause by clause where required. Where a clause cannot be settled, it is recorded as an open question with a named owner and a date rather than adopted in ambiguous terms.	Decision	Drafting group convenor / AMA/TC1/2026/05 Rev.1
10:30–10:50	Coffee break	—	—
10:50–12:20	Item 11. Overarching Continental Procedure for Evaluations — second reading and adoption, together with the indicative timelines annexed to it.	Decision	Drafting group convenor / AMA/TC1/2026/06 Rev.1
12:20–12:30	Item 12. Interfaces with other Technical Committees: the evidence the Committee relies on from Inspections, Quality Control Laboratories, Clinical Trials Oversight and Vigilance, and the points at which those Committees are consulted during an evaluation.	Discussion	AMA Technical Lead
12:30–14:00	Lunch	—	—
14:00–15:15	Item 13. Adoption of the Committee's workplan for 2027: priority deliverables, owners, timelines, meeting rhythm and the resources required from the Secretariat and from member authorities. The draft workplan is circulated in advance and finalised in session.	Decision	Chairperson / AMA/TC1/2026/07
15:15–15:45	Item 14. Agreement of the Committee's report and its recommendations to the AMRC on 29 October, including the two adopted instruments and any open questions. The report is presented to the Conference by the Chairperson.	Decision	Chairperson / AMA/TC1/2026/08
15:45–16:00	Item 15. Any other business and close.	Decision	Chairperson
16:00–17:00	Joint consolidation session of all seven Committees.	—	All Chairs, Vice-Chairs and rapporteurs

Expected outputs: adopted terms of reference and rules of procedure; adopted Product Eligibility Criteria; adopted Overarching Continental Procedure for Evaluations with indicative timelines; Chairperson and Vice-Chairperson elected at Meeting I; adopted workplan for 2027; and the Committee report presented by the Chairperson at the AMRC.

Reference	Document	Status at tabling
AMA/TC1/2026/01	Draft agenda and programme of work	For adoption
AMA/TC1/2026/02	Draft terms of reference of the Committee	For adoption
AMA/TC1/2026/03	Draft rules of procedure	For adoption
AMA/TC1/2026/04	AMA strategy and Secretariat update — evaluation function	For information
AMA/TC1/2026/05	Draft Product Eligibility Criteria for continental listing	First and second reading
AMA/TC1/2026/05-BG	Record of the industry consultation of 25 October	Background
AMA/TC1/2026/06	Draft Overarching Continental Procedure for Evaluations	First and second reading
AMA/TC1/2026/07	Draft workplan 2027	For adoption
AMA/TC1/2026/08	Draft report and recommendations to the AMRC	For adoption

9.2 Technical Committee on Regulatory Inspections — GMP and GCP

Committee	Technical Committee on Regulatory Inspections — GMP and GCP (TC2)
Meeting I	Monday 26 October 2026, 13:30–17:00 — closed, members only
Meeting II	Wednesday 28 October 2026, 09:00–16:00 — closed, members only
Preceded by	Inauguration of the seven AMA Technical Committees and the orientation plenary, Monday 26 October, 09:00–12:30 (open)
Followed by	Joint consolidation session of all seven Committees, Wednesday 28 October, 16:00–17:00
Venue	Marriott Hotel, Kigali (26 October); Ubumwe Grande Hotel, Kigali (28 October). Room allocation to be confirmed
Chairing	Chaired pro tem by the AMA Secretariat until the Chairperson is elected
Secretariat	AMA Secretariat — accountable officer and rapporteur designated before circulation
Documents tabled for decision	Inspections Playbook — Part A, Good Manufacturing Practice; Part B, Good Clinical Practice (AMA/TC2/2026/05)

The Committee meets to constitute itself, to adopt its terms of reference, rules of procedure and workplan, and to take first and second readings of the Inspections Playbook. The Playbook is the operational instrument through which the Agency and National Regulatory Authorities plan, conduct, share and rely upon inspections, and it is intended for adoption before the Committee Chairperson reports to the African Medicines Regulators Conference on 29 October.

Inspection capacity is unevenly distributed across the continent. The Playbook is therefore as much about reliance, work-sharing and the joint use of a continental inspector pool as it is about inspection technique.

Meeting I — Monday 26 October 2026, 13:30–17:00

Time	Agenda item and purpose	Action	Lead / document
13:30–13:40	Item 1. Opening, welcome and introduction of members. Confirmation of attendance and of the quorum.	Information	AMA Secretariat
13:40–13:50	Item 2. Adoption of the agenda and the programme of work for the two meetings.	Decision	Chair pro tem / AMA/TC2/2026/01
13:50–14:20	Item 3. Terms of reference of the Committee. Scope across GMP and GCP inspections, membership, conflict of interest and declarations, confidentiality of inspection findings, and the relationship to National Regulatory Authorities and RECs that retain the power to inspect and to act on findings.	Decision	AMA Secretariat / AMA/TC2/2026/02
14:20–14:45	Item 4. Rules of procedure. Onboarding, convening, quorum, decision-making, drafting groups, observers and record-keeping.	Decision	AMA Secretariat / AMA/TC2/2026/03

Time	Agenda item and purpose	Action	Lead / document
14:45–15:10	Item 5. Election of the Chairperson and the Vice-Chairperson of the Committee, in accordance with the rules of procedure adopted at Item 4. Terms of office and handover arrangements.	Decision	AMA Secretariat presiding
15:10–15:30	Coffee break	—	—
15:30–16:30	Item 6. Inspections Playbook — first reading, Part A (Good Manufacturing Practice). Presentation (20 minutes) and discussion (50 minutes) on risk-based planning and site prioritisation; triggers for inspection, including inspections requested during an evaluation; the conduct of joint and observed inspections; composition and leadership of inspection teams; the continental inspector pool, qualification and maintenance of competence; a common inspection report format; a common classification of deficiencies and critical findings; corrective and preventive action, follow-up and re-inspection; confidentiality and the lawful sharing of inspection outcomes; the inspection of active pharmaceutical ingredient and drug substance manufacturing sites; and the conditions under which one authority may rely on another's inspection.	Discussion; text referred to a drafting group	Chairperson / AMA/TC2/2026/05
16:30–16:50	Item 7. The continental inspector pool: nomination by authorities, qualification framework, training pipeline through the Capacity Strengthening Hub, mentoring of inspectors from authorities at earlier maturity levels, and cost and release arrangements with employing authorities.	Discussion	Capacity Strengthening Hub Lead / AMA/TC2/2026/06
16:50–17:00	Item 8. Summary of the session. Constitution of the drafting group, with named members and a reporting time of 09:00 on 28 October. Housekeeping.	Decision	Chairperson
17:00–17:45	Committee Chairs' debrief with the AMA Secretariat	—	—
Evening	Drafting group works on the revised Part A text	—	Drafting group convenor

Meeting II — Wednesday 28 October 2026, 09:00–16:00

Time	Agenda item and purpose	Action	Lead / document
09:00–09:15	Item 9. Recap of Meeting I and confirmation of the outcomes recorded. Report from the drafting group.	Information	Chair pro tem; drafting group convenor

Time	Agenda item and purpose	Action	Lead / document
09:15–10:45	Item 10. Inspections Playbook, Part A (GMP) — second reading and adoption, together with the common report format and the deficiency classification annexed to it. Clauses that cannot be settled are recorded as open questions with a named owner and a date.	Decision	Drafting group convenor / AMA/TC2/2026/05 Rev.1
10:45–11:05	Coffee break	—	—
11:05–11:50	Item 11. Inspections Playbook, Part B (Good Clinical Practice) — first and second reading. Trial site inspections, sponsor and contract research organisation inspections, triggers arising from an application under evaluation, joint GCP inspections, and the division of responsibility with the Technical Committee on Clinical Trials Oversight.	Decision	AMA Technical Lead / AMA/TC2/2026/05 Part B
11:50–12:15	Item 12. Reliance on inspection outcomes: the legal and practical conditions for an authority to accept another's inspection, the standing of WHO-listed authority and maturity level 3 inspectorates, the information-sharing arrangements required, and what the Agency publishes.	Discussion	AMA Technical Lead
12:15–12:30	Item 13. Inspection of medical device manufacturing facilities, including the draft quality management system audit document. Inspection of medical device facilities sits with this Committee rather than with the Medical Devices, Diagnostics and Emerging Technologies Committee.	Discussion	AMA Technical Lead
12:30–14:00	Lunch	—	—
14:00–15:15	Item 14. Adoption of the Committee's workplan for 2027: priority deliverables, the inspection programme, owners, timelines, meeting rhythm and the resources required. The draft workplan is circulated in advance and finalised in session.	Decision	Chairperson / AMA/TC2/2026/07
15:15–15:45	Item 15. Agreement of the Committee's report and its recommendations to the AMRC on 29 October, presented to the Conference by the Chairperson.	Decision	Chairperson / AMA/TC2/2026/08
15:45–16:00	Item 16. Any other business and close.	Decision	Chairperson
16:00–17:00	Joint consolidation session of all seven Committees.	—	All Chairs, Vice-Chairs and rapporteurs

Expected outputs: adopted terms of reference and rules of procedure; adopted Inspections Playbook Parts A and B with the common report format and deficiency classification; agreed arrangements for the continental inspector pool and its training pipeline; Chairperson and Vice-Chairperson elected at Meeting I; adopted workplan for 2027 including the inspection programme; and the Committee report presented by the Chairperson at the AMRC.

Reference	Document	Status at tabling
AMA/TC2/2026/01	Draft agenda and programme of work	For adoption
AMA/TC2/2026/02	Draft terms of reference of the Committee	For adoption
AMA/TC2/2026/03	Draft rules of procedure	For adoption
AMA/TC2/2026/04	AMA strategy and Secretariat update — inspections function	For information
AMA/TC2/2026/05	Draft Inspections Playbook, Parts A and B, with annexes	First and second reading
AMA/TC2/2026/06	Continental inspector pool — qualification and training framework	For discussion
AMA/TC2/2026/07	Draft workplan 2027	For adoption
AMA/TC2/2026/08	Draft report and recommendations to the AMRC	For adoption

9.3 Technical Committee on Market Intelligence and Control

Committee	Technical Committee on Market Intelligence and Control (TC5)
Meeting I	Monday 26 October 2026, 13:30–17:00 — closed, members only
Meeting II	Wednesday 28 October 2026, 09:00–16:00 — closed, members only
Preceded by	Inauguration of the seven AMA Technical Committees and the orientation plenary, Monday 26 October, 09:00–12:30 (open)
Followed by	Joint consolidation session of all seven Committees, Wednesday 28 October, 16:00–17:00
Venue	Marriott Hotel, Kigali (26 October); Ubumwe Grande Hotel, Kigali (28 October). Room allocation to be confirmed
Chairing	Chairperson and Vice-Chairperson elected at Meeting I
Secretariat	AMA Secretariat — accountable officer and rapporteur designated before circulation
Documents tabled for decision	Market Surveillance Procedure, drafted on the basis of the Post-Market Surveillance Guideline

The Committee meets to constitute itself, to elect its Chairperson and Vice-Chairperson, to adopt its terms of reference, and to take a first reading of the Market Surveillance Procedure. On the second day the Committee adopts its 2027 workplan and considers the Continental Market Surveillance Campaign Plan for Cycles 1 and 2, including a status update on Cycle 1, which will already have been initiated. The Committee also convenes a joint session with the Technical Committee on Quality Control Laboratories and Laboratory Networks to align on the sample campaign plan and the NARL Overarching Procedure, given the dependency between market surveillance sampling and laboratory testing capacity.

Meeting I — Monday 26 October 2026, 13:30–17:00

Time	Agenda item and purpose	Action	Lead / document
13:30–13:40	Opening, welcome and introduction of members. Confirmation of attendance and of the quorum.	Information	AMA Secretariat
13:40–13:50	Adoption of the agenda and the programme of work for the two meetings.	Decision	Chair pro tem
13:50–14:50	Presentation and discussion of the terms of reference of the Committee.	Decision	AMA Secretariat
14:50–15:30	Voting session: election of the Chairperson and the Vice-Chairperson of the Committee, following consideration of the terms of reference.	Decision	AMA Secretariat presiding
15:30–16:00	Coffee break	—	All

Time	Agenda item and purpose	Action	Lead / document
16:00–17:00	Market Surveillance Procedure — first reading. Presentation of the draft procedure, developed from the Post-Market Surveillance Guideline.	Discussion	AMA Technical Lead
17:00	End of Meeting I	Information	Chairperson
17:00–17:45	Committee Chairs' debrief with the AMA Secretariat (Chairperson, Vice-Chairperson and accountable officer only)	—	—

Meeting II — Wednesday 28 October 2026, 09:00–16:00

Time	Agenda item and purpose	Action	Lead / document
09:00–09:15	Recap of Meeting I and confirmation of the outcomes recorded.	Information	Chairperson
09:15–10:15	Market Surveillance Procedure — second reading and adoption.	Decision	Chairperson / AMA Technical Lead
10:15–10:35	Coffee break	—	All
10:35–11:20	Review and adoption of the Committee's workplan for 2027.	Decision	Chairperson
11:20–13:00	Presentation and discussion of the Continental Market Surveillance Campaign Plan for Cycles 1 and 2, including the current status of Cycle 1.	Discussion	AMA Technical Lead
13:00–14:00	Lunch	—	All
14:00–15:30	Joint session with the Technical Committee on Quality Control Laboratories and Laboratory Networks: alignment on the sample campaign plan and the NARL Overarching Procedure, including the points at which each Committee refers matters to the other.	Discussion	Chairpersons of the two Committees
15:30–15:45	Coffee break	—	All
15:45–16:00	Agreement of the Committee's report and its recommendations to the AMRC on 29 October, including the adopted Market Surveillance Procedure and the campaign plan status, presented to the Conference by the Chairperson.	Decision	Chairperson
16:00–17:00	Joint consolidation session of all seven Committees.	—	All Chairs, Vice-Chairs and rapporteurs

Expected outputs: elected Chairperson and Vice-Chairperson; adopted terms of reference; adopted Market Surveillance Procedure with indicative timelines; adopted workplan for 2027; the Continental Market Surveillance Campaign Plan for Cycles 1 and 2 considered, with a recorded status update on Cycle 1 and a scoping note for Cycle 2; the outcomes of the joint session with the Laboratories Committee recorded; and the Committee report presented by the Chairperson at the AMRC.

Document	Status at tabling
Draft agenda and programme of work	For adoption
Draft terms of reference of the Committee	For adoption
Post-Market Surveillance Guideline	Background
Draft Market Surveillance Procedure	First and second reading
Draft workplan 2027	For adoption
Continental Market Surveillance Campaign Plan — Cycles 1 and 2	For discussion
Cycle 1 status update	For information
Draft NARL Overarching Procedure (joint session document)	For discussion
Draft report and recommendations to the AMRC	For adoption

9.4 Technical Committee on Vigilance

Committee	Technical Committee on Vigilance (TC6)
Meeting I	Monday 26 October 2026, 13:30–17:00 — closed, members only
Meeting II	Wednesday 28 October 2026, 09:00–16:00 — closed, members only
Preceded by	Inauguration of the seven AMA Technical Committees and the orientation plenary, Monday 26 October, 09:00–12:30 (open)
Followed by	Joint consolidation session of all seven Committees, Wednesday 28 October, 16:00–17:00
Venue	Marriott Hotel, Kigali (26 October); Ubumwe Grande Hotel, Kigali (28 October). Room allocation to be confirmed
Chairing	Chairperson and Vice-Chairperson confirmed at Meeting I
Secretariat	AMA Secretariat — accountable officer and rapporteur designated before circulation
Documents tabled for decision	Terms of reference and rules of procedure; draft Continental Vigilance Framework

The Committee meets to constitute itself, to confirm its Chairperson and Vice-Chairperson, to consider its terms of reference and rules of procedure, and to identify its priority technical deliverables. On the second day the Committee reviews its annual workplan and takes up the draft Continental Vigilance Framework and the workflow between vigilance and the evaluation of medicines, vaccines and biologicals.

Meeting I — Monday 26 October 2026, 13:30–17:45

Time	Activity	Responsible
13:30–13:45	Registration and seating	AMA Secretariat
13:45–14:00	Opening remarks and adoption of the agenda	AMA Pharmacovigilance Lead
14:00–15:00	Discussion and consideration of the terms of reference and rules of procedure	AMA Secretariat / all
15:00–15:30	Voting and confirmation of the Chairperson and Vice-Chairperson of the Committee, following consideration of the terms of reference	Coordinated by the AMA Secretariat
15:30–15:45	Tea break	All
15:45–16:45	Continued discussion of the terms of reference and rules of procedure; identification of priority technical deliverables	Chairperson / all
16:45–17:15	Consolidation of agreed amendments to the terms of reference and rules of procedure	Chairperson / all
17:15–17:45	Committee Chairs' debrief with the AMA Secretariat	Chairperson

Meeting II — Wednesday 28 October 2026, 09:00–17:00

Time	Activity	Responsible
09:00–09:30	Presentation of the draft annual workplan of the Committee	AMA Secretariat / Committee Coordinator
09:30–11:00	Discussion of the draft workplan	Chairperson / all
11:00–11:30	Tea break	All
11:30–13:00	Continued review of the draft workplan; confirmation of priority deliverables and indicative timelines	Chairperson / all
13:00–14:00	Lunch break	All
14:00–15:30	Review and discussion of the draft Continental Vigilance Framework, and of the workflow and linkage between vigilance and the evaluation of medicines, vaccines and biologicals	Chairperson / all
15:30–16:00	Agreement of the Committee's report and recommendations to the AMRC	Chairperson / all
16:00–16:15	Tea break	All
16:15–17:00	Joint consolidation session of all seven Committees: alignment of the seven workplans and preparation of the Committee reports to the AMRC	Chairs, Vice-Chairs, rapporteurs and accountable officers
Evening	Rapporteurs finalise the Committee report for presentation to the AMRC	Rapporteur

Expected outputs: confirmed Chairperson and Vice-Chairperson; agreed terms of reference and rules of procedure; identified priority technical deliverables; reviewed annual workplan with indicative timelines; the draft Continental Vigilance Framework considered together with the vigilance-to-evaluation workflow; and the Committee report tabled at the AMRC.

9.5 Technical Committee on Quality Control Laboratories and Laboratory Networks

Committee	Technical Committee on Quality Control Laboratories and Laboratory Networks (TC7)
Meeting I	Monday 26 October 2026, 13:30–17:00 — closed, members only
Meeting II	Wednesday 28 October 2026, 09:00–16:00 — closed, members only
Preceded by	Inauguration of the seven AMA Technical Committees and the orientation plenary, Monday 26 October, 09:00–12:30 (open)
Followed by	Joint consolidation session of all seven Committees, Wednesday 28 October, 16:00–17:00
Venue	Marriott Hotel, Kigali (26 October); Ubumwe Grande Hotel, Kigali (28 October). Room allocation to be confirmed
Chairing	Chairperson and Vice-Chairperson elected at Meeting I
Secretariat	AMA Secretariat — accountable officer and rapporteur designated before circulation
Documents tabled for decision	NARL Overarching Procedure

The Committee meets to constitute itself, to elect its Chairperson and Vice-Chairperson, to adopt its terms of reference, and to take a first reading of the NARL Overarching Procedure. On the second day the Committee takes the procedure to a second reading and adoption, receives a presentation on the sample campaign plan and the current status of Cycle 1, adopts its 2027 workplan, and convenes a joint session with the Technical Committee on Market Intelligence and Control.

Meeting I — Monday 26 October 2026, 13:30–17:00

Time	Agenda item and purpose	Action	Lead / document
13:30–13:40	Opening, welcome and introduction of members. Confirmation of attendance and of the quorum.	Information	AMA Secretariat
13:40–13:50	Adoption of the agenda and the programme of work for the two meetings.	Decision	AMA Secretariat
13:50–14:30	Presentation and discussion of the terms of reference of the Committee.	Decision	AMA Secretariat
14:30–15:10	Voting session: election of the Chairperson and the Vice-Chairperson of the Committee, following consideration of the terms of reference.	Decision	AMA Secretariat presiding
15:10–15:30	Coffee break	—	All
15:30–17:00	NARL Overarching Procedure — first reading. Presentation of the draft procedure.	Discussion	AMA Technical Lead

Time	Agenda item and purpose	Action	Lead / document
17:00	End of Meeting I	Information	Chairperson
17:00–17:45	Committee Chairs' debrief with the AMA Secretariat	—	—

Meeting II — Wednesday 28 October 2026, 09:00–16:00

Time	Agenda item and purpose	Action	Lead / document
09:00–09:15	Recap of Meeting I and confirmation of the outcomes recorded. Report from the drafting group on the NARL Overarching Procedure.	Information	Chairperson
09:15–10:15	NARL Overarching Procedure — second reading and adoption.	Decision	Chairperson
10:15–10:35	Coffee break	—	All
10:35–11:30	Adoption of the Committee's workplan for 2027.	Decision	Chairperson / AMA Technical Lead
11:30–12:30	Continental Market Surveillance Campaign Plan: current status of Cycle 1 and laboratory capacity implications.	Discussion	AMA Technical Lead
12:30–14:00	Lunch	—	All
14:00–15:30	Joint session with the Technical Committee on Market Intelligence and Control: alignment on the sample campaign plan and the NARL Overarching Procedure, including the points at which each Committee refers matters to the other.	Discussion	Chairpersons of the two Committees
15:30–15:45	Coffee break	—	All
15:45–16:00	Agreement of the Committee's report and its recommendations to the AMRC on 29 October, including the adopted NARL Overarching Procedure and the campaign plan status, presented to the Conference by the Chairperson.	Decision	Chairperson
16:00–17:00	Joint consolidation session of all seven Committees.	—	All Chairs, Vice-Chairs and rapporteurs

Expected outputs: elected Chairperson and Vice-Chairperson; adopted terms of reference; adopted NARL Overarching Procedure with indicative timelines; the sample campaign plan for Cycles 1 and 2 presented with a recorded status update on Cycle 1 and a scoping note on Cycle 2 laboratory capacity; adopted workplan for 2027; the outcomes of the joint session with the Market Intelligence and Control Committee recorded; and the Committee report presented by the Chairperson at the AMRC.

Document	Status at tabling
Draft agenda and programme of work	For adoption
Draft terms of reference of the Committee	For adoption
Draft NARL Overarching Procedure	First and second reading
Continental Market Surveillance Campaign Plan — Cycles 1 and 2 (joint session document)	For discussion
Cycle 1 status update	For information
Draft workplan 2027	For adoption
Draft report and recommendations to the AMRC	For adoption

Approved by: _____ Director-General, African Medicines Agency

Date: _____

Prepared by the AMA Secretariat, 8 October 2026.

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